

ALEXANDRA SIMONE GORDON

Instructional Designer | Professional Development Specialist | Adult Learning Facilitator

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Portfolio: imalexofalltrades.netlify.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer and professional development specialist with 10+ years of experience designing, facilitating, and scaling learning systems that produce measurable outcomes for educators and learners. Deep expertise in adult learning theory, curriculum development, and coaching across K-12, nonprofit, and corporate contexts. Proven at building multi-modal learning experiences from the ground up: from needs analysis and content architecture through delivery, feedback, and iterative improvement. Author of original instructional frameworks deployed to 4,000-5,000 learners annually; designer of PD systems that have achieved 95%+ educator engagement and driven a 238% improvement in student outcomes. Equally fluent in synchronous, asynchronous, and hybrid modalities, with hands-on experience in Nearpod, Peardeck, Google Suite, Canva, and Adobe Express. Brings a practitioner's credibility, a coach's instincts, and a systems thinker's approach to every engagement.

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

238%

Improvement in student outcomes (DREAM Program)

95%

Educator engagement & retention rate

4,000+

Learners served annually via curriculum

90+

Educators trained per PD cycle

20

NYC school sites scaled across

500+

Curriculum materials produced annually

40+

Unique PD workshops delivered per year

1,500+

Learners impacted by technology integration

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Instructional Design (ADDIE, Backwards Design)
- Adult Learning Theory & Andragogy
- Curriculum Architecture & Standards Alignment
- Professional Development Design & Facilitation
- Needs Analysis & Stakeholder Engagement
- Asynchronous, Hybrid & Remote Learning Design
- Instructional Coaching & Structured Feedback Cycles
- Train-the-Trainer Program Development
- Data-Driven Program Improvement
- LMS Design & Educational Technology Integration
- AI Tools Training & Facilitation
- Cross-Functional Collaboration & Capacity Building

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer & Professional Development Consultant (Independent)

2025 – Present

Alex of All Trades

- **Curriculum & Training Design:** Design custom training modules, full curriculum, facilitator guides, and participant materials for K-12, nonprofit, and corporate clients; all projects begin with a structured needs analysis and include at least two rounds of revision for alignment and quality.
- **Live PD Workshops & Facilitation:** Design and facilitate half-day and full-day professional learning workshops for educator and professional audiences, using engagement-forward delivery methods grounded in adult learning theory; virtual and in-person delivery available.

- **Program Consultation:** Provide comprehensive program audits, learning outcomes strategy, and ongoing consultation for organizations seeking measurable improvement in training effectiveness; prior engagements have driven up to 238% improvement in learner outcomes.
- **Facilitator Coaching:** Offer 1:1 facilitator and trainer coaching including observation, detailed feedback, engagement strategy development, and presentation skills refinement; train-the-trainer programs available at custom scope.
- **AI Tools & Technology Training:** Design and deliver AI literacy training and tool walkthroughs for educators and business professionals, mapping specific use cases across workflows and translating complex tools into immediately actionable practice.
- **Zoom Production & Webinar Management:** Produce and facilitate virtual events and professional webinars including full tech management, speaker coordination, live chat moderation, and post-event resource delivery.

Professional Learning Facilitator & Webinar Moderator

Nov 2025 – Present

The Mistral Collective (Freelance)

- **Executive Audience Facilitation:** Design and moderate live professional webinars for business executives on integrating AI into organizational practice, adapting complex technical content into accessible, immediately applicable learning for non-educator senior-level adult learners.
- **Adult Learning Design:** Apply andragogical principles, strengths-based facilitation, and iterative engagement strategies to remote professional learning contexts, demonstrating fluency in both K-12 and corporate learning environments.

Senior Instructional Designer

July 2017 – January 2025

DREAM Program / SHSI, NYC Department of Education

- **Lead Curriculum Architect:** Served as lead instructional designer for the NYC DOE DREAM Program, authoring a comprehensive, multi-modal ELA curriculum delivered to 4,000-5,000 students annually across 20 sites in all five boroughs; curriculum drove a 238% improvement in specialized high school acceptance rates, the highest in program history.
- **Proprietary Framework Development:** Developed two original instructional frameworks, WWH (non-fiction roadmapping) and COTS (fiction roadmapping), for timed SHSAT test preparation; codified into training materials and deployed to 90+ instructors city-wide, producing outcomes no prior program iteration had achieved.
- **PD System Design & Facilitation:** Designed and facilitated 3 full PD cycles annually for 90+ educators, including onboarding PD at program launch and ongoing professional learning; delivered 40+ unique workshops per year; 100% of participants demonstrated improved instructional practice on follow-up observation.
- **Scalable Observation & Feedback Systems:** Built and managed a scalable observation and feedback system across 20 school sites, standardizing tools for instructional data collection, analysis, and targeted coaching; achieved 95% instructor satisfaction and retention rate.
- **Needs Analysis & Continuous Improvement:** Partnered with program leadership and site supervisors through structured pre-visit needs analysis, school visits, and post-visit debriefs to identify PD priorities and iteratively improve curriculum and coaching at scale.
- **Asynchronous & Remote Learning:** Independently designed, coordinated, and managed asynchronous and hybrid learning content via Nearpod and Google Suite across 20 sites; maintained consistent curriculum delivery and educator access throughout full remote periods.

Instructional Coach

Aug 2022 – June 2023

UFT Teacher Center, NYC Department of Education

- **Professional Development Committee Chair:** Chaired a 10-person cross-departmental PD committee designing adult-learning-centered professional workshops grounded in strengths mapping and iterative feedback; contributed to 95% educator engagement and an 80% increase in student outcomes.
- **New Teacher Onboarding & Coaching:** Successfully transitioned 10 first-year instructors into independent practice through a full-year onboarding coaching cycle; provided ongoing individual and small-group coaching to experienced teachers through formal cycles including co-planning, co-teaching, modeling, and classroom intervisitation.
- **Technology Integration Training:** Designed and facilitated technology training workshops for 50+ instructors in asynchronous delivery, hybrid instruction, and self-guided learning platforms; contributed to a 75% increase in instructor technology integration and 200% improvement in learner engagement across 1,500+ students.

- **Program Assessment & Feedback Loops:** Designed and administered post-PD feedback and evaluation tools after every workshop, newsletter, and community event; used results to collaboratively improve program design and document measurable impact, achieving a 50% improvement in learner and instructor outcomes.
- **Learning Community Development:** Sustained a school-wide continuous learning culture through monthly best-practices newsletters, community events, and a structured instructional book study for 10 educators, building shared accountability and iterative growth across the year.

K-12 Curriculum Designer & Literacy Specialist

Aug 2014 – Jan 2025

NYC Department of Education (5 schools, 3 boroughs)

- **Differentiated Curriculum Development:** Designed and developed 500+ standards-aligned, differentiated curriculum materials annually in collaboration with teams of 2-5 subject matter experts, serving 1,000+ diverse learners across secondary grades 6-12 including students with disabilities and English Language Learners.
- **Inclusive & Cross-Content Design:** Designed evidence-based literacy instruction and content scaffolds across all secondary subject areas using co-teaching models, UDL principles, and individualized IEP-aligned supports; maintained a 90% standardized test passing rate annually and 85%+ academic growth for struggling readers.
- **LMS & Technology Integration:** Maintained and managed LMS systems including Google Classroom; integrated Nearpod, Peardeck, and collaborative digital tools to enhance content delivery and learner engagement across in-person, hybrid, and fully remote learning environments.
- **Sharing Best Practices & Building Capacity:** Regularly shared evidence-based learning theory and literacy implementation strategies with 30+ colleagues annually, contributing to school-wide curriculum alignment and an 80% improvement in overall educational outcomes.
- **Assessment Design & Data Use:** Developed assessment and evaluation tools for 1,000+ learners to identify learning needs, measure progress, and collaboratively improve curriculum through targeted, data-informed iteration.

SELECTED PROJECTS & OUTCOMES

- DREAM Program ELA Curriculum (NYC DOE, 2017-2025): Full program design for 4,000-5,000 students/year; 3 annual development cycles; multi-modal, culturally responsive, hybrid-ready; drove 238% improvement in specialized high school admissions.
- Educator Onboarding PD System (DREAM Program, 2017): Designed and facilitated full onboarding for 90+ educators at program launch using strengths-based needs analysis; 100% of participants improved instructional practice on post-observation follow-up.
- Technology Integration Curriculum (UFT Teacher Center, 2022-23): Workshop series for 50+ instructors in asynchronous delivery and hybrid instruction; 75% technology integration increase; 200% improvement in learner engagement across 1,500+ students.
- Proprietary Reading Frameworks WWH & COTS (DREAM Program): Original non-fiction and fiction roadmapping frameworks developed for SHSAT timed reading; codified into training materials and deployed to 90+ instructors city-wide.
- New Teacher Onboarding Coaching Program (UFT Teacher Center, 2022-23): Full-year coaching cycle for 10 first-year teachers; formal coaching cycles including co-planning, co-teaching, modeling, and intervisitation.
- AI Integration Webinar Series (Mistral Collective, 2025-Present): Live professional development for business executives on AI adoption; remote delivery for senior-level adult learners outside education sector.

EDUCATION

M.S., Special Education and Teaching

Long Island University, Brooklyn Campus | GPA: 3.91 | Graduated Summa Cum Laude

Social justice-driven program with emphasis on urban education, differentiated instruction, UDL, and IEP implementation through a social-constructivist lens

B.A., Cultural Anthropology

Binghamton University | GPA: 3.71 | Graduated Magna Cum Laude | Phi Eta Sigma Honors Society

Certificate, TEFL: Teaching English as a Foreign Language

Via Lingua, Crete, Greece | 120-hour course including observed teaching practice

CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

Google Certified Educator

Adobe Creative Educator Level 1

NY & NM Licensed Educator (Level 3 Professional)

TECHNOLOGY & TOOLS

- LMS: Google Classroom, Nearpod, Peardeck
- Design & Content: Canva, Adobe Express
- Remote Delivery: Zoom (production & facilitation)
- Productivity: Google Suite, Microsoft Suite
- Asynchronous & Hybrid Delivery Platforms
- AI Tools: Training, use-case mapping, facilitation

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

- Literacy Design Collaborative (2015-2016): Backwards design framework for skill-based literacy curricula; weekly coaching with LDC coach
- NYC DOE CRSE Fellowship: 1 of 50 educators city-wide; developed and disseminated culturally responsive, sustaining education practices for NYC schools and communities
- Urban Advantage Science Inquiry: Collaborative inquiry through partnerships between NYC public schools and cultural institutions including museums and science centers
- Teachers College Inclusive Classrooms Project; Social Emotional Learning for All Students; Teach Uncommon Approaches to the Common Core
- UFT Chapter Leadership & Training: Created and led a flagship UFT chapter; built consultation, MOSL, Safety, and SLT committees